belonging to the physical environment. They take it for granted that sensory perception is our basic mode of acquiring knowledge. The Buddhist ***Dignaga*** distinguishes sharply between two types of mental process: perception, which is free from conceptual interpretation and language, and mental construction (***vikalpa/kalpana***). The former relates directly to reality – a flux of inexpressible, momentary particulars: the latter organises that flux of instants under general concepts and is thus at one remove from the data of experience. ***Dignaga*** denies that perceptual experiences can be expressed in words. They are thus incommunicable. This disjunction is resisted by the ***Nyaya*** thinkers and those influenced by them. They hold that some reliable perceptions involve concepts and are linguistically expressible (***savikalpaka-pratyaksha***), while others are concept free (***nirvikalpaka-pratyaksha***).

Further reading: G. Bhattacharya 1989; Franco 1994; Matilal 1986; Mohanty 1992; Potter 1977

Pratyaya (four causal factors): ***Abhidharma*** Buddhists, who think that the primary data of awareness are provided by realities external to the mind, analyse events as complexes (*samagri*) comprising four types of causal conditions: a preceding moment in any sort of series is called the immediate condition (*samanantara-pratyaya*); an object-condition (*alambana-pratyaya*); an efficient condition (*adhipati-pratyaya*); and attendant circumstantial conditions (*hetu-pratyaya*). A perception such as that of the colour red would be analysed as a complex event:

1. The immediately preceding moment in the stream of consciousness (*samanantara-pratyaya*).
2. A flash of red atoms (*alambana-pratyaya* or objective condition).